



CARLISLE CASTLE

THE MOST
DISTINGUISHED
SURNAME
EMERSON

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The illustrious name literally means 'the son of Emery,' ^[1] or 'Emery's Son.' ^[2] The name Emery dates back to the Domesday Book ^[3] when the Latin version Amalricus, was first listed. ^[4]

ANCIENT HISTORY

The bleak border moors and craggy hills of the Scottish/English border set the scene for the birth of this notable surname Emerson. It is one of the oldest surnames with a history which is closely woven into the rich and beautiful tapestry of the border chronicles.

Professional researchers examined some of the most ancient manuscripts such as the Exchequer Rolls of Scotland, the Inquisitio, the Ragman Rolls, the Domesday Book, baptismals, parish records and cartularies, and tax records, and researchers found the first record of the name Emerson in Durham at Finchdale, where William Emeryson was recorded in 1411. Later in 1498, Cuthbert Emerson was listed as a Freeman of York in 1498. ^[4]

Richard Emryson, Yorkshire was listed in Historia Dunelmensis, but no dates were listed. Surtees Society also lists William Emeryson, Yorkshire: Priory of Finchale; and Richard Emerson, Yorkshire Testamenta Eboracensia. ^[1]

"The Emersons, who lived at Hill Close House, Darlington,[Durham] for centuries, are still represented in that town and its neighbourhood." ^[5]

SPELLING VARIATIONS

The early and middle development of the name showed many different spellings in the archives. The name Emerson, occurred in many references, and from time to time, the surname was spelled Emerson, Emmerson and Emerston, and these changes in spelling frequently occurred within the family name. Scribes and church officials spelt the name as it sounded, and these spellings were not even consistent during the lifetime of the same person.



Ancestors of the family name Emerson are believed to be descended originally from the Boernicians. This ancient founding race of the north were a mixture of Scottish Picts and Angles, a race dating from about the year 400 A.D. Their territories ranged from Edinburgh in the north, southward to the North Riding of Yorkshire in England. By 1000 A.D. this race had formed into discernible Clans and families, perhaps some of the first evidence of the family structure in Britain. From this area come some of the most impressive names in history, surnames with strange nicknames such as the Sturdy Armstrongs, the Gallant Grahams, the Saucy Scotts, the Angry Kerrs, the Bells, the Nixons, the Famous Dicksons, the Bold Rutherfords, the Pudding Somervilles, and most of the names ending in "son."

Amongst this elite circle of clans and families the earliest record of the surname Emerson was found in Durham where they were recorded as a family of great antiquity seated at Foxton with manor and estates in that shire. A tradition of the family has it that they are descended from Emeric, a Northumbrian Chieftain who settled in Durham and later acquired territories north of the border in Scotland in Dumfriesshire. However, there is equal claim that they are descended from one Roger D'Emeris, a Norman noble from Tours who was granted lands by Duke William of Normandy in Isle Brewers, in Somerset where he is recorded in the Domesday Book in 1086. It is known he moved north to Newcastle about 1100. They branched to Newcastle on Tyne and acquired estates in Lincolnshire and Norfolk. They also intermarried with the Lords Modbury in Devon. Here the name changed to Emerston, but there is a provable continuity in the Coat of Arms.

EARLY NOTABLES

Notable amongst the family members during their early history was William Emerson (1701-1782), English mathematician, the son of Dudley Emerson, a schoolmaster, was born at Hurworth, Durham, on 14 May 1701. He was first educated by his father and a curate who boarded in the house, and was afterwards sent to school at Newcastle, and then at York. Returning to Hurworth, he took pupils, but possessing no gift of teaching, and his temper being warm, he soon lost them, and determined to live on the income of 70l. or 80l. left him by his father.^[6]



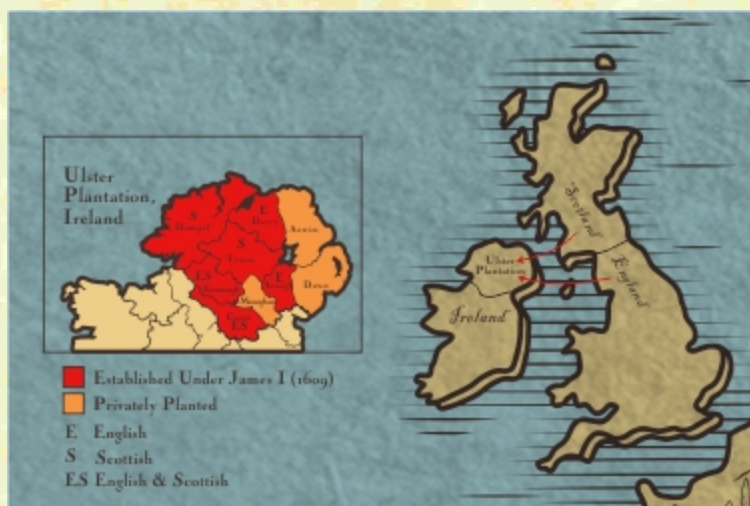


The border area of Scotland and England reached from Carlisle in the west to Berwick in the east. The Clans or families to the north of the border became Scottish after about the year 1000, and to the south they became English. Nevertheless, despite the border, many would still be united clans, powers unto themselves, owing little allegiance to either Scotland or England, having territories and interests on both sides of the border. Clan warfare became so intense that in 1246 A.D., six Chiefs from the Scottish side and six from the English side met at Carlisle and produced a set of laws for all the border territory. These were unlike any laws prevailing in England or Scotland or, for that matter, anywhere else in the world. For example, it was a far greater offence to refuse to help a neighbour recover his property, wife, sheep, cattle or horses than it was to steal them in the first place. For refusal of assistance a person could be hanged on the instant, without a trial. While clans were on this "hot trod," from which we get the modern expression "hot to trot," they were protected from almost all eventualities.

In 1603, the crowns of Scotland and England were united under James VI of Scotland who found it expedient to disperse the "unruly border clans." In 1587, an Act of Scottish Parliament had condemned certain border families for their lawlessness.

The Border Clans, largely the Strathclyde Britons on the western border, and the Boernicians on the Eastern Border Marches, were dispersed to England, northern Scotland and to Ireland. Some were banished directly to the Colonies.

In Ireland, they were granted lands previously held by the Catholic Irish. They signed an "Undertaking" to remain Protestant and faithful to the Crown. In Ireland they settled in Dublin and Armagh. In the latter county they intermarried with the Tennents, the notable financiers, originally of Scotland. In 1890, a birth census of English families in Ireland was taken. From that census, it was estimated that there were over 806 people bearing the surname Emerson throughout Ireland; about 72 percent were living in the province of Ulster where the families were found in Down and Antrim.^[7]





Life in Ireland was intolerant to many of these uprooted families and they sailed aboard the armada of sailing ships known as the "White Sails" which plied the stormy Atlantic. These overcrowded ships often arrived with only 60 to 70 percent of their original passenger list, many dying on the way, were buried at sea.

SETTLERS

- William Emerson, who arrived in Virginia in 1618 aboard the ship "Sampson" ^[8]
- Thomas Emerson, aged 11, who arrived in Virginia in 1623 aboard the ship "George" ^[8]
- Mrs. Ann Emerson, settled in Virginia in 1623 from Durham aboard the ship "George"
- Ellis Emerson, who arrived in Virginia in 1623 aboard the ship "George" ^[8]
- Jo Emerson, aged 20, British settler who arrived in New England in 1635 aboard the ship "Abigail" ^[8]
- Thomas Emerson, who arrived in Ipswich, Massachusetts in 1639 ^[8]
- Nicholas Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1642 ^[8]
- John Emerson, who landed in Ipswich, Massachusetts in 1648 ^[8]
- Ed Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1651 ^[8]
- Nicholas Emerson, who settled in Virginia in 1653
- Mich Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1653 ^[8]
- Michael Emerson, who arrived in Massachusetts in 1656 ^[8]
- Humphrey Emerson, who arrived in Maryland in 1663 ^[8]
- Paul Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1664 ^[8]
- Anthony Emerson, who arrived in Maryland in 1665 ^[8]
- Joseph Emerson, who arrived in Massachusetts in 1667 ^[8]

As well as 36 more in the Appendix.



CURRENT NOTABLES

In America, these new immigrants became the backbone of the first settlements from Maine to the Cumberland Gap. They provided much of the stock which produced the early presidents and governors of the United States. In Canada they settled Nova Scotia, the St. Lawrence and the Ottawa Valley. During the American War of Independence those loyal to the Crown moved northward into Canada and became known as the United Empire Loyalists.

- Claudia Emerson (b.1957) American poet awarded the 2006 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry collection *Late Wife*, Poet Laureate of Virginia by Governor Tim Kaine in 2008
- Ernest Allen Emerson II (1954-2024) American computer scientist and winner of the 2007 Turing Award
- William Robert Emerson (1925-2023) known during his recording career as Billy "The Kid" Emerson and later as Rev. William R. Emerson, an American preacher and former R&B and rock and roll singer and songwriter, best known for his 1955 song, "Red Hot."
- William Hundley "Bill" Emerson Jr. (1938-2021) American five-string banjo player, one of the founding members of the original The Country Gentlemen and Emerson & Waldron and considered one of the finest bluegrass banjo players in music history
- Billy "The Kid" Emerson (b.1929) American R&B and rock and roll singer and songwriter
- William Emerson (1701-1782) English mathematician, son of Dudley Emerson, a schoolmaster, born at Hurworth, Durham, on 14 May 1701
[9]
- Keith Noel Emerson (1944-2016) English keyboardist and composer, founding member of Emerson, Lake & Palmer (ELP)
- Michael Emerson (b.1954) American stage and screen actor
- Hope Emerson (1897-1960) American film actress
- David Emerson (b.1945) Canadian politician, businessman, civil servant

- Craig Emerson (b.1954) Australian Labor Party representative from Queensland

As well as 149 more in the Appendix.



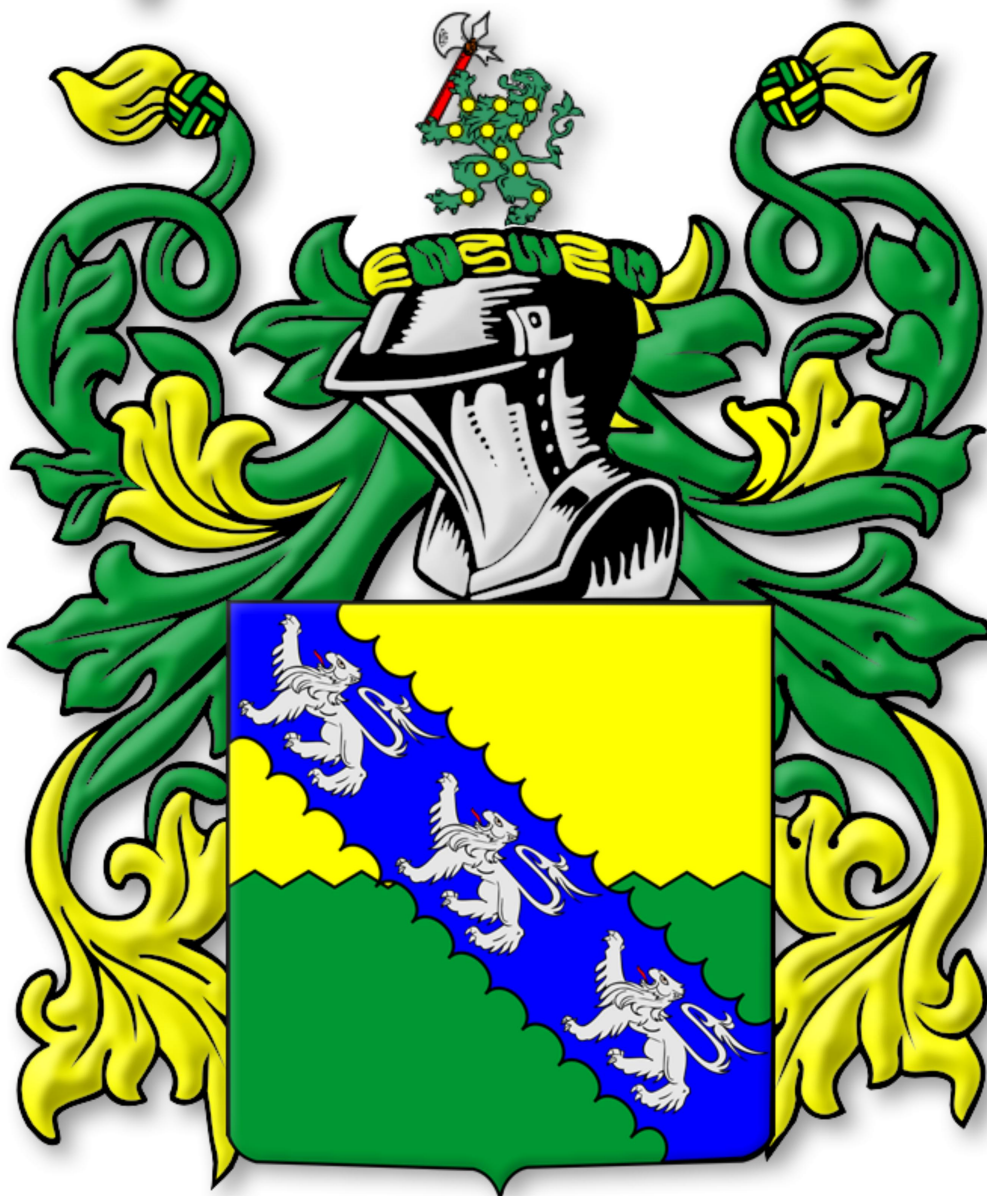


- Mr. Frank L. Emerson, American employee of the Grover Shoe factory in Brockton, Massachusetts on 20th March 1905 when the boiler exploded and collapsed the wooden building; he died ^[10]
- Miss Georgie B. Emerson, American employee of the Grover Shoe factory in Brockton, Massachusetts on 20th March 1905 when the boiler exploded and collapsed the wooden building; she died ^[10]
- Mr. S. M. H. Emerson, Australian crew member aboard the ship "SS Yongala" when she went missing in a Cyclone on 23-24 March 1911 everyone was presumed dead

As well as 3 more in the Appendix.



The Ancient Arms of



Emerson



The practice of representing people with symbols is ancient, and in England this habit evolved with feudal society into a system of distinctive devices on shields. The heralds developed an extensive armory that had the important function of distinguishing members of the upper class from each other, whether at court or on the battlefield. Since then, heraldry has grown into a complex field with many rules and a terminology that requires some knowledge to interpret.



An Achievement of Arms such as the Emerson arms depicted on the left typically consists of these parts: the Escrolls, displaying the family motto and name, the family crest (if any) seen above the helmet, the actual Coat of arms (also known as 'arms,' or 'the shield'), the Helmet depicted below the crest, the Torse on top of the helmet, and the Mantle draped from the helmet. Each of these elements will be described below. Supporters were a later addition to the Achievement; they are somewhat rare, and are usually personal to the grantee.



MANTLE OF EMERSON

The mantle was spread over and draped from the helmet and served as a protection, 'to repel the extremities of wet, cold, and heat, and to preserve the armour from rust.' The numerous cuts and slits suggest that it had been torn and hacked on the field of battle. The style or design of the mantling is up to the individual heraldic artist, and it is usually depicted in the main color and metal from the shield. The helmet (or Helm) varied in shape in different ages and countries, often depicting rank. The Esquire's Helm, as depicted here, is generally shown silver, with a closed visor and facing to the dexter (its right). On top of the helmet is a Torse or wreath which was formed by two pieces of silk twisted together. Its purpose was to hold the crest and mantle on the Helm.

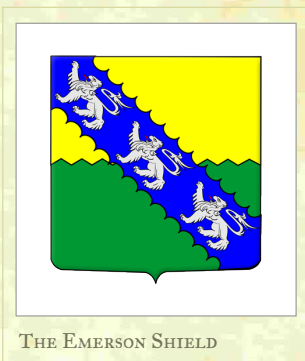
MOTTO

The motto was originally a war cry or slogan. Mottoes first began to be shown with arms in the 14th and 15th centuries, but were not in general use until the 17th century. Thus the oldest coats of arms generally do not include a motto. Mottoes seldom form part of the grant of arms: Under most heraldic authorities, a motto is an optional component of the coat of arms, and can be added to or changed at will; many families have chosen not to display a motto.

The coat of arms displayed here for the surname Emerson did not include a motto.

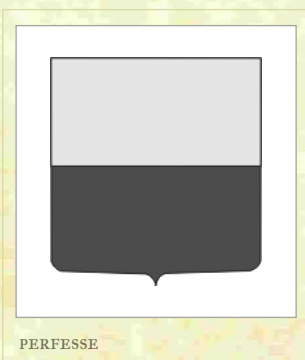
SHIELD

Shields (or Escutcheons) at first were painted simply with one or more bands of color or 'ordinaries'. Later, the ordinaries were used in conjunction with other figures or symbols. The Coat of Arms for the surname Emerson can be described as follows:



EMERSON ARMS

A shield divided per fesse indented gold and green with three silver lions passant on a blue bend engrailed.

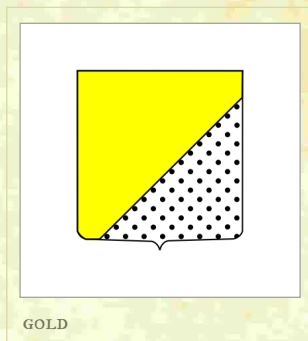


PERFESSE

Dividing a shield per fesse involves creating two equal parts of the shield using a horizontal partition line. It is thought to hold no symbolism of its own, but allows for two colors, each with its own symbolism to be displayed.

INDENTED

An indented line of partition is graded so that at an angle it resembles a flight of square steps and vertically or horizontally it looks like a row of small triangles, side by side and points facing out.

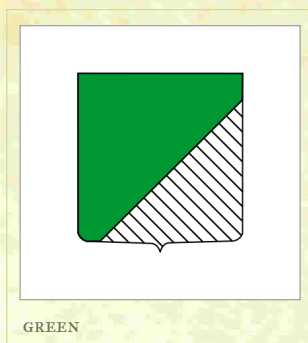


GOLD

"Or" (from the French word for gold) is the tincture of Gold, or in heraldic terms "or," was considered the noblest color.

One of only two metals used in heraldry, it exceeds all others in value, purity and finesse. It represents the light of the sun, and was once borne only by princes. Gold is said to gladden the heart and destroy all works of magic. It is also associated with excellence and achievement, and the bearer surpasses all others in valor.

It is represented on coats of arms by the color yellow, and in engravings by a dotted pattern.



GREEN

"Vert" (from the French word for green) signifies felicity and pleasure. It was symbolic of joy, youth and beauty. Green was also associated with the spring. The bearer of the green is obliged to defend the peasant and all who work on the land. It is expressed in engravings by lines in bend, or slanting to the right.

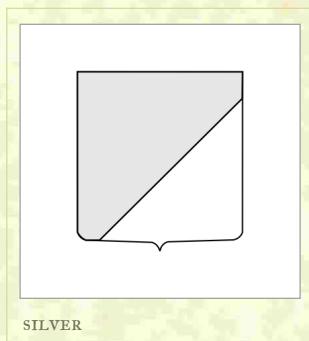
THREE

"Three" devices, beasts or ordinaries of the same have a special significance in heraldry.

First of all, there is the obvious reference to the Trinity in the design that would signify observance of the Christian doctrine.

Secondly, with many Arms it brings balance that is steeped in tradition. To better understand this latter scenario, we must look at the evolution of shield in personal armory. Kite shields that were the most popular from the the 10th-14th century evolved into Heater shields that had flat tops c. 1250. This was the time of heraldry's beginnings and when "three" objects were used for balance in each corner of the shield.

Later, with the advent of the "chief," "chevron" and "bend" three devices brought balance to these ordinaries too.



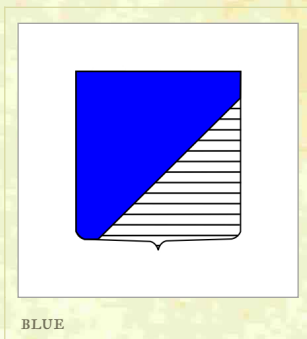
SILVER

Argent (from the French for silver), or Silver is one of the two metals used in heraldry. It is usually represented on a shield by the colors gray or white.

This metal represents nobility, peace and serenity. It is associated with the qualities of purity and chastity, because the metal withstands the test of fire.

PASSANT

A beast described as passant is one that is walking to the dexter, with the dexter (right) fore-paw raised. The lions of England are passant guardant.



BLUE

Azure (derived from the French word for "blue") represents the color of an eastern sky on a clear day. It also corresponds to the metal tin. The word, "azure" was introduced from the east during the Crusades. It signifies piety and sincerity, and is equated with autumn. In engravings it is represented by horizontal lines.



BEND

The bend is a broad, diagonal band across the shield representing either a scarf worn like a sash, or the shield suspender of a knight or military commander. It has often been granted to those who have distinguished themselves as commodores.

The bend signifies defense and protection, and is "a bearing of high honour, and probably represents either the scarf of the shield suspender of a knight or military commander. It was, like most other bearings, at first assumed by men of knightly and military rank, and it has since often been granted by the heralds to those who have distinguished themselves as commanders." ^[11]

Unless it is specified otherwise the bend is assumed to go from the upper left corner (dexter, chief in heraldic terms) of a shield to the lower right (sinister base). The Bend Sinister follows the opposite diagonal and is equally as honourable as the Bend Dexter and denotes the "badge of honour for a commander. A great many people who have paid no attention to heraldry speak of the 'bend sinister' as though it meant a mark of illegitimacy, but it is really nothing of the kind." ^[11]

According to old theorists the bend should occupy one third of the surface of a shield, though it is usually drawn slightly more narrowly than this. A charge half the width of a bend is termed a bendlet, and if six or eight of these pieces occurs on a shield it is termed 'bendy.'

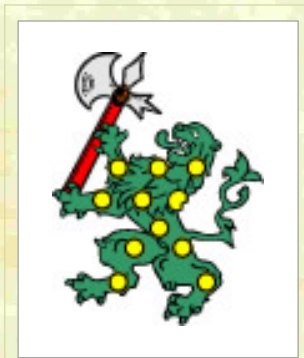
The bend sinister has been used occasionally as a mark of illegitimacy though this is not commonly the case. More often a bendlet sinister is used, or a baton sinister, which is a bendlet that does not extend to the very edges of the shield.

ENGRAILED

An engrailed line of partition has an edge drawn with a row of many sharp little waves.

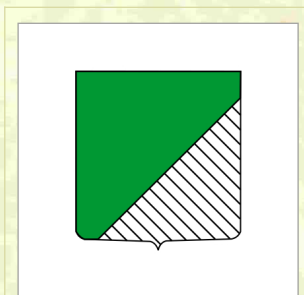
THE CREST

The Crest was worn on top of the helmet, and was usually made of wood, metal, or boiled leather. It provided the double advantage of easy identification and the addition of height to the wearer. The Crest for the surname Emerson is described as follows:



THE EMERSON CREST

A GREEN LION BEZANTÉE HOLDING A RED BATTLE-AXE WITH A SILVER HEAD.



GREEN

GREEN

"Vert" (from the French word for green) signifies felicity and pleasure. It was symbolic of joy, youth and beauty. Green was also associated with the spring. The bearer of the green is obliged to defend the peasant and all who work on the land. It is expressed in engravings by lines in bend, or slanting to the right.



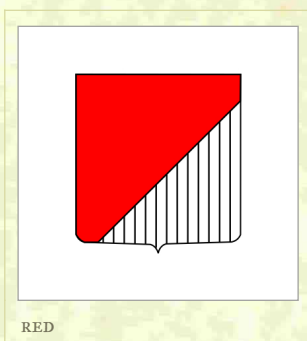
LION

The lion has always held a high place in heraldry as the emblem of deathless courage, and, hence, that of a valiant warrior. It is said to be a lively image of a good soldier, who must be "valiant in courage, strong of body, politic in council and a foe to fear."

Through the somewhat dubious legend of their compassion, lions also came to symbolize Christ. As one medieval author asserted, "they prey on men rather than women, and they do not kill children except when they are very hungry."

The Lion, with such repute of its noble nature and having the position and title of king of the beasts, is naturally one of the most common heraldic symbols on the continent of Europe. The winged lion is the emblem of St. Mark.

"The earliest example to be found is on the seal of Philip I., Duke of Flanders, in 1164. " ^[12]



RED

Gules, derived from an Old French word goules or gueules meaning "throats" translates into modern English as "red" and is the military color for excellence and fortitude. It is symbolic of nobility, boldness and ferocity, and can also represent fire and summer. Some ancient laws restricted its use to princes and their families. Red corresponds to the metal copper and is denoted in engravings by numerous perpendicular lines.



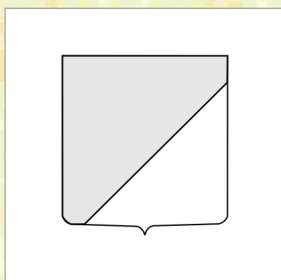
BATTLE-AXE

BATTLE-AXE

The Battle-Axe or Axe is a symbol of authority and of the execution of military duty. ^[11]

The Battle-Axe denoted a warlike quality its bearer. The Battle-Axe was a bearing introduced to heraldry as a token of the Crusades, which began shortly after the rise of heraldry itself.

Though other axes are used as devices in heraldry, the Battle-Axe is distinct because of its blade that it firmly mounted on the shaft and penetrates through it to the other side. It is a common symbol on a crest.



SILVER

SILVER

Argent (from the French for silver), or Silver is one of the two metals used in heraldry. It is usually represented on a shield by the colors gray or white.

This metal represents nobility, peace and serenity. It is associated with the qualities of purity and chastity, because the metal withstands the test of fire.

HEAD

The Human Head stands for honor. After all, the Head is the center of knowledge, thinking and learning for the body.

"The heads of 'blackamoors' or negroes generally refer to deeds of prowess in the Crusades." ^[11]



SUGGESTED FURTHER READINGS

"Englis Roots of the Haverhill and Ipswich Emerson" by Ralph Stanton Emerson.

"A Genealogy of the Emerson Family of Vallejo, California: A Branch of the Haverhill Emersons of Massachusetts and New Hampshire" by Robley Emerson Passalacqua.

Please note: We do not have these publications in our library. They come from the catalog of Genealogical titles in the collection of the Library of Congress. Most of these Genealogies were published by their authors, probably with one small print run. You can locate these publications through the Library of Congress (<http://catalog.loc.gov/webvoy.htm>), or we would suggest trying to contact a library in the locale of publication (you may be able to use inter-library loan, through your local library).





APPENDIX - NOTABLE LIST

NOTABLES FOR THE SURNAME EMERSON

- Claudia Emerson (b.1957) American poet awarded the 2006 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry collection Late Wife, Poet Laureate of Virginia by Governor Tim Kaine in 2008
- Ernest Allen Emerson II (1954-2024) American computer scientist and winner of the 2007 Turing Award
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- Michael Emerson (b.1954) American stage and screen actor
- Hope Emerson (1897-1960) American film actress
- David Emerson (b.1945) Canadian politician, businessman, civil servant
- Craig Emerson (b.1954) Australian Labor Party representative from Queensland
- Gary Emerson (b.1963) English golfer and winner of the 2004 Russian Open
- Denise Emerson (b.1960) Australian cricketer
- Hunt Emerson (b.1952) English cartoonist and graphic novelist
- George Barrell Emerson (1797-1881) American Educator and pioneer of women's education rights
- Jonathan Emerson (1874-1956) American screen actor
- Ralph Waldo Emerson (1803-1882) American poet, essayist, and philosopher, he was called "the sage of Concord" in his home town in Massachusetts, and became the chief spokesman for Transcendentalism
- Roy Stanley Emerson (b.1936) Australian former tennis player who won 12 Grand Slam singles titles and 16 Grand Slam men's doubles titles

- William O. Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of New Hampshire State House of Representatives from Dalton; Elected 1938; Delegate to New Hampshire State Constitutional Convention from Dalton, 1948^[13]
- William N. Emerson, American politician, Member of New York State Senate 28th District, 1876-77^[13]
- William J. Emerson, American politician, Circuit Judge in Illinois 15th Circuit, 1925^[13]
- William Emerson, American politician, Candidate for Presidential Elector for Virginia, 1932^[13]
- William Emerson, American politician, Farmer-Labor Candidate for U.S. Representative from Illinois 2nd District, 1922^[13]
- Walter C. Emerson, American politician, Candidate for U.S. Representative from Maine 1st District, 1914^[13]
- W. E. Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 14th District, 1913-14^[13]
- Ulysses F. Emerson, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Massachusetts, 1940^[13]
- Susan Emerson, American Republican politician, Candidate for Delegate to U.S. Congress from the District of Columbia, 1992^[13]
- Stephen Ray Emerson, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Iowa, 1936^[13]
- Sigurd A. Emerson, American politician, Delegate to New Jersey State Constitutional Convention from Union County, 1947^[13]
- Sandy Emerson, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Louisiana, 1988^[13]
- Samuel F. Emerson, American politician, Prohibition Candidate for U.S. Representative from Maine 3rd District, 1906, 1912, 1914, 1916^[13]
- Samuel Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 6th District, 1859-60^[13]
- Robert L. Emerson (b.1948) American Democratic Party politician, Member of Michigan State House of Representatives, 1980-97; Member of Michigan State Senate 29th District, 1999-^[13]
- Richard Emerson (1875-1944) American Republican politician, Member of Michigan State House of Representatives, 1921-24, 1927-28; Defeated in primary, 1924, 1928^[13]
- Ralph Waldo Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Candidate in primary for Michigan State House of Representatives from Wayne County 1st District, 1950^[13]
- Ralph Waldo Emerson (1892-1963) American Republican politician, Fruit broker; Delegate to Republican National Convention from Delaware, 1940^[13]
- Phillip H. Emerson, American politician, Justice of Utah Territorial Supreme Court, 1873-76^[13]

- Norvell William Emerson (1938-1996) American Republican politician, U.S. Representative from Missouri, 1981-96^[13]
- Mary Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Presidential Elector for Michigan, 1968^[13]
- M. D. Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Texas, 1952^[13]
- Lyndes Emerson, American politician, Member of New York State Assembly from Saratoga County, 1843^[13]
- Louis Woodard Emerson (1857-1924) American Republican politician, Member of New York State Senate 19th District, 1890-93; U.S. Representative from New York 23rd District, 1899-1903^[13]
- Josiah D. Emerson, American Republican politician, Candidate for Ohio State House of Representatives from Logan County, 1897^[13]
- Jonathan Emerson, American Republican politician, Postmaster at Smyrna, Delaware, 1861-73^[13]
- John H. Emerson, American politician, Delegate to Iowa State Constitutional Convention 30th District, 1857^[13]
- John F. Emerson, American politician, Member of Massachusetts State House of Representatives from New Bedford; Elected 1839^[13]
- John B. Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from California, 2000; Member, Credentials Committee, 2008^[13]
- John Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from California, 1988^[13]
- Jo Ann Emerson (b.1950) American Republican politician, U.S. Representative from Missouri 8th District, 1996-^[13]
- James O. Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of Connecticut State House of Representatives from Roxbury; Elected 1918^[13]
- James M. Emerson, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Connecticut, 1916^[13]
- James Alfred Emerson (1865-1922) American Republican politician, Member of New York State Senate, 1907-18^[13]
- Jabez Oscar Emerson (1875-1968) American Republican politician, Member of Kansas State House of Representatives, 1911-13; Mayor of Kansas City, Kansas, 1926-27; Appointed 1926; Defeated, 1927^[13]
- J. N. Emerson, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Washington, 1932 (alternate), 1936, 1940 (alternate), 1944^[13]
- Hugh P. Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Postmaster at Miami, Florida, 1942-48^[13]
- Henry Ivory Emerson (1871-1953) American Republican politician, U.S. Representative from Ohio 22nd District, 1915-21 ; Candidate in primary for Lieutenant Governor of Ohio, 1924, 1926^[13]

- Henry A. Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 9th District, 1913-14 ^[13]
- H. T. Emerson, American Republican politician, Mayor of Menominee, Michigan; Elected 1910 ^[13]
- George Y. Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of New Hampshire State House of Representatives from Rochester 2nd Ward; Elected 1938 ^[13]
- George Reed Emerson, American politician, U.S. Vice Consul in Antilla, 1926; Valparaiso, 1927 ^[13]
- George Emerson (1848-1921) American politician, Mayor of Winfield, Kansas, 1883-84 ^[13]
- Frank W. Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of New Hampshire State House of Representatives from Hampstead; Elected 1938 ^[13]
- Frank Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of Wyoming State House of Representatives, 1950 ^[13]
- Fermon Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Member of Michigan Democratic State Central Committee, 1969 ^[13]
- F. G. Emerson, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Kansas, 1916 ^[13]
- Emery H. Emerson Jr., American Democratic Party politician, Candidate for South Dakota State Auditor, 1952 ^[13]
- Elizabeth H. Emerson, American politician, Justice of New York Supreme Court 10th District; Elected 2009 ^[13]
- Edward P. Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 7th District, 1863-65 ^[13]
- Delmont Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of Maine State Senate 16th District, 1919-22 ^[13]
- David W. Emerson, American politician, Prohibition Candidate for Governor of Wisconsin, 1914; Prohibition Candidate for U.S. Senator from Wisconsin, 1928 ^[13]
- David Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 7th District, 1796 ^[13]
- Daniel Emerson Jr., American politician, Member of New Hampshire Governor's Council, 1787-88 ^[13]
- Charles S. Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of New Hampshire State House of Representatives from Milford; Elected 1938; Delegate to New Hampshire State Constitutional Convention from Milford, 1948 ^[13]
- Charles E. Emerson, American politician, Prohibition Candidate for U.S. Representative from Maine 2nd District, 1910 ^[13]
- Charles C. Emerson (b.1852) American Republican politician, Member of Vermont State House of Representatives from Thetford, 1888 ^[13]
- Charles Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from South Dakota, 1944 ^[13]

- Charles Emerson (d.1870) American politician, Delegate to Illinois State Constitutional Convention 40th District, 1869-70^[13]
- C. W. Emerson, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Utah Territory, 1880^[13]
- Bulkley Emerson, American politician, Postmaster at Bangor, Maine, 1800-01, 1801-06^[13]
- Bodwell Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 8th District, 1828-30^[13]
- Andrew L. Emerson, American politician, Mayor of Portland, Maine, 1832^[13]
- Allan Emerson, American politician, Member of Illinois State House of Representatives, 1838-41^[13]
- Alfred E. Emerson, American Republican politician, Member of New York State Assembly from Jefferson County, 1927^[13]
- Albert Emerson, American Republican politician, Alternate Delegate to Republican National Convention from Illinois, 1880^[13]
- Abram Emerson, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Texas, 1980^[13]
- Abraham Emerson, American politician, Member of New Hampshire State Senate 2nd District, 1846-48^[13]
- A. M. P. Emerson, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Maine, 1856^[13]

SURNAME VARIANTS OF EMERSON

- Simon Emmerson (1956-2023) British Grammy Award-nominated record producer, guitarist, DJ and founder of the group Afro Celt Sound System
- Robert Leslie "Les" Emmerson (1944-2021) Canadian musician, lead vocalist and guitarist for the band Five Man Electrical Band, and their predecessor band The Staccatos
- Mr. Gavin Arran Emmerson M.B.E., British Warrant Officer Class 1 for the Royal Logistic Corps was appointed Member of the Order of the British Empire on 17th June 2017
- Archie Amerson (b.1974) American former running back in the Canadian Football League, Walter Payton Award winner in 1996
- Lucius Amerson, the first African American Sheriff in the South since Reconstruction in 1967
- Glenn Douglas Amerson (b.1938) American professional NFL football defensive back for the Philadelphia Eagles in 1961
- Stephen "Steve" Amerson (b.1954) American singer, songwriter, and recording artist
- David Amerson (b.1991) American football cornerback for the Washington Redskins
- Henry Read Emmerson (1883-1954) Canadian business executive and politician, Member of the Canadian Parliament for Westmorland (1935-1949), son of Henry Robert Emmerson

- Riley Emmerson (b.1986) Canadian NHL ice hockey left winger from Burnaby, British Columbia
- Louis Lincoln Emmerson (1863-1941) American politician, 27th Governor of Illinois (1929-1933), 24th Illinois Secretary of State (1917-1929)
- Henry Robert Emmerson PC (1853-1914) Canadian lawyer, businessman, politician, and philanthropist, 9th Premier of New Brunswick (1897-1900)
- William "Bill" Emmerson (b.1945) American politician, Member of the California State Senate (2012-)
- William Emmerson, American politician, Member of North Carolina House of Commons from Iredell County, 1844-45 ^[14]
- Thomas Emmerson (1772-1837) American politician, Mayor of Knoxville, Tennessee, 1815-17 ^[14]
- John K. Emmerson, American politician, U.S. Vice Consul in Osaka, 1938 ^[14]
- John Emmerson, American Democratic Party politician, Alternate Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Louisiana, 1940 ^[14]
- George Emmerson, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Indiana, 1860 ^[14]
- John W. Emison, American Republican politician, Chair of Knox County Republican Party, 1905 ^[14]
- James W. Emison, American Republican politician, Delegate to Republican National Convention from Indiana, 1908 ^[14]

NOTABLES WITH THE FIRST AND MIDDLE NAMES EMERSON

- Robert Emerson Lucas Jr. (1937-2023) American economist at the University of Chicago, known for developing the classical approach to macroeconomics for which he received the Nobel Prize in Economics in 1995
- Emerson de Souza Ferretti (b.1971) Brazilian former football goalkeeper
- Foster Emerson Sylvers (1962-2026) American singer, songwriter, record producer and multi-instrumentalist
- Emerson "Emeng" David Pascual (b.1972) Filipino politician and businessman
- Howard Emerson Flight (1948-2026) Baron Flight, a British Conservative politician, Member of the House of Lords from 1997 to 2005, Shadow Economic Secretary to the Treasury from 1999 to 2001, Shadow Paymaster General from 2001 to 2002, and Shadow Chief Secretary to the Treasury from 2002 to 2004
- Emerson Newton- John (b.1974) American professional racing driver, most notably in NASCAR, the ARCA Racing Series, and the Indy Lights Series
- Dale Emerson Saffels (1921-2002) American lawyer, legislator, and United States district judge of the United States District Court for the District of Kansas (1990-2002)
- William Emerson Brock III (1930-2021) American politician from Tennessee
- Emerson Lincoln Allsworth (1926-2023) American politician and lawyer, Member of the Florida House of Representatives from 1959 to 1966
- Emerson dos Santos da Luz (b.1982) Cape Verdean footballer who currently plays for Canelas 2010

- Thomas Emerson Headlam (1813-1875) English judge advocate-general, eldest son of John Headlam, Archdeacon of Richmond and Rector of Wycliffe, Yorkshire, who was buried there on 9 May 1853, aged 85^[9]
- Sir James Emerson Tennent (1804-1869) 1st Baronet, British politician, 5th Colonial Secretary of Ceylon (1846-1850), third son of William Emerson (d. 1821), merchant of Belfast
- Emerson Muschamp Bainbridge (1817-1892) English co-founder of Bainbridge's, a major department store in Eldon Square in the centre of Newcastle upon Tyne, England in 1838, re-branded as John Lewis Newcastle in 1974
- Emerson Stone, American Democratic Party politician, Delegate to Democratic National Convention from Texas, 1944^[15]
- Emerson Columbus Harrington (1864-1945) American Democratic Party politician, Dorchester County State's Attorney, 1899-1903; Maryland Insurance Commissioner, 1911; Governor of Maryland, 1916-20^[15]
- Emerson Augusto Thome (b.1972) also known as Paredão, a Brazilian retired footballer
- Emerson Harold "Eli" Fly (1935-2017) American academic, President of the University of Tennessee system (2001-2002)
- Robert Emerson Windom (1930-2016) American physician, United States Assistant Secretary for Health and Human Services (1986-1989)
- Emerson J. Griffith, American politician, Member of California State Assembly 4th District, 1881-83^[16]
- Emerson Hodges, American politician, Member of Minnesota State Senate 8th District, 1857-60^[17]
- Emerson Wight (1815-1890) American Republican politician, Mayor of Springfield, Massachusetts, 1875-78^[18]
- Emerson Lancoe Ard, American politician, Member of South Carolina State Senate from Williamsburg County, 1927-34^[18]
- Charles Emerson Hovey (1885-1911) American officer in the United States Navy, eponym of the USS Hovey (DD-208)
- Gordon Emerson Romkey (1885-1977) Canadian merchant and politician who represented Lunenburg in the Nova Scotia House of Assembly from 1928 to 1953, Speaker of the Nova Scotia House of Assembly (1940-1953)
- Joseph Emerson Worcester (1784-1865) American lexicographer who was part of the "dictionary wars" with competitor Noah Webster of Webster's Dictionary
- Reverend George Emerson Quaile, American founder of Salisbury School, in Salisbury, Connecticut in 1901
- Emerson Swinford, American guitarist, composer/songwriter and producer, best known as the guitarist in the Rod Stewart band
- Emerson McMillin (1844-1922) American philanthropist and founder of E. McMillin and Company, a banking firm in New York in 1891, eponym of the McMillin Observatory, Ohio State University

- Edward Emerson Cuffee (1902-1959) American jazz trombonist, he played with Leon Abbey (1940), Count Basie (1941), Chris Columbus (1944), and Bunk Johnson (1947)
- Ralph Emerson Twitchell (1859-1925) American historicist businessman and politician, Mayor of Santa Fe, New Mexico, and Chairman of the Rio Grande Commission
- George Emerson Dickman (1914-1981) American Major League Baseball relief pitcher for the Boston Red Sox 1936 to 1941
- Amos Emerson Dolbear (1837-1910) American physicist and inventor who developed Dolbear's law which states the relationship between the air temperature and the rate at which crickets chirp in 1897
- Gabriel Emerson Olds (b.1974) American actor and freelance writer
- James Emerson Foor (b.1949) retired American Major League baseball pitcher who played from 1971 to 1973
- George Emerson Albee (1845-1918) American officer in the United States Army, recipient of the Medal of Honor for his actions during the Indian Wars
- Emerson Muschamp Bainbridge (1845-1911) English mining consulting engineer, philanthropist and Liberal Party politician
- Harry Emerson Wildes (1890-1982) American sociologist, historian and writer, best known for his biographies of William Penn
- Graeme Emerson Bell AO MBE (1914-2012) Australian Dixieland and classical jazz pianist, composer and band leader
- Kermit Emerson Wahl (1922-1987) American Major League Baseball infielder
- Emerson Cesario (b.1988) Brazilian football player
- Major-General Louis Emerson Hibbs (1893-1970) American Commandant of the Field Artillery School (1945-1946)^[19]
- Brigadier-General Floyed Emerson Galloway (1890-1955) American Commanding Officer Crissy field (1943)^[20]
- Emerson Hough (1857-1923) American author best known for writing western stories
- Brigadier-General Don Emerson Carleton (1899-1977) American Chief of Staff 3rd Army (1945-1946)^[21]
- Emerson Ramos Borges (b.1980) Brazilian footballer
- George Emerson Conklin (1921-1942) American marine soldier, recipient of the Navy Cross, eponym of the USS Conklin (DE-439)
- Harry Emerson Rowbottom (1884-1934) U.S. Congressional Representative from Indiana
- Walter Emerson Baum (1884-1956) American artist and educator
- Emerson G Higdon, American manufacturing company executive
- Harry Emerson Fosdick (1878-1969) American Liberal Protestant preacher and author from Buffalo, New York



APPENDIX - HISTORIC EVENT LIST

GROVER SHOE FACTORY

Brockton, Massachusetts was home to R. B. Grover Shoe factory where 35,000 shoe workers were employed. As the morning of 20th March 1905 was a little cool, the engineer fed the old boiler coal. The new boiler required a maintenance flush so was temporarily out of service. Mr. Rockwell wanted the building to be warm for the staff. At 7:45 A.M. the plant manager called to complain about some odd noises in the pipes. He was reassured it was in order. A few minutes later the boiler exploded out of the building through the three floors and roof to land in the home of Miss Mary Pratt. The explosion knocked over the water tower at one end of the building which then smashed through the roof and caused that end of the building to immediately collapse. Many of the 300 workers were trapped by the collapse and burning coals thrown from the boilers fire pit started small fires which burned quickly on the timbers. One hundred and fifty workers were injured and 58 died.



VIEW OF DISASTER, MARCH 1905. THE ARROW SHOWS THE TRAJECTORY OF THE BOILER.

- Mr. Frank L. Emerson, American employee of the Grover Shoe factory in Brockton, Massachusetts on 20th March 1905 when the boiler exploded and collapsed the wooden building; he died ^[10]
- Miss Georgie B. Emerson, American employee of the Grover Shoe factory in Brockton, Massachusetts on 20th March 1905 when the boiler exploded and collapsed the wooden building; she died ^[10]

HALIFAX EXPLOSION

In the morning of December 6, 1917 the cargo ship SS Mont-Blanc carrying high explosives collided with the Norwegian SS Imo causing a devastating explosion that affected the Richmond district in Halifax, Nova Scotia. Around 2,000 people died due to the debris and the fires from the blast wave that radiated over 1,000 metres per second.



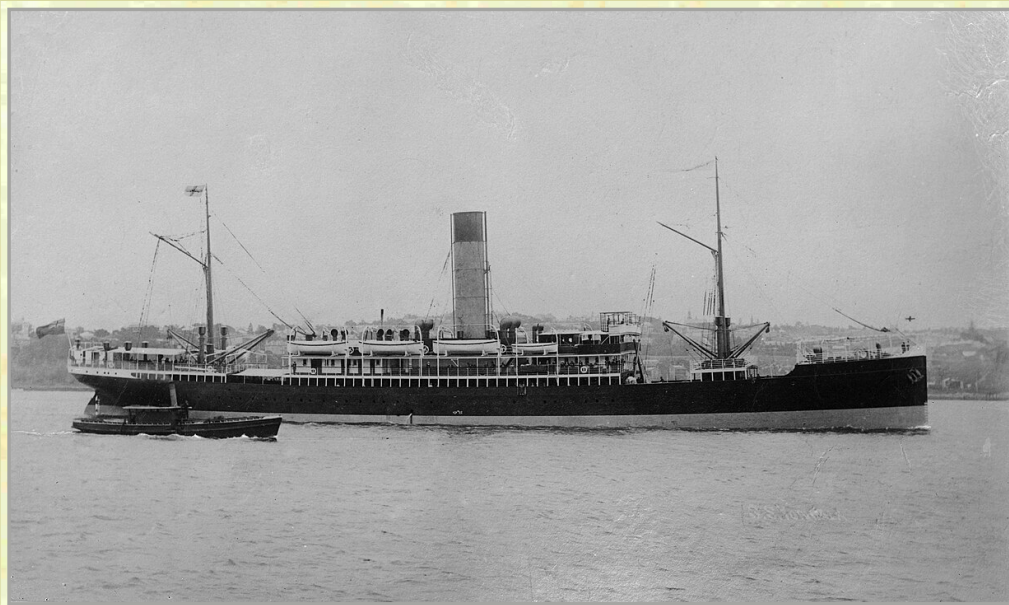
HALIFAX EXPLOSION

SURNAME VARIANTS OF EMERSON

- Miss Cecilia Emmerson (1913-1917) Canadian resident from Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada who died in the Halifax Explosion (1917)^[22]
- Master Rupert Emmerson (1915-1917) Canadian resident from Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada who died in the Halifax Explosion (1917)^[22]

SS YONGALA

In 1911 on the 23rd and 24th of March a cyclone came through between Townsville and Mackay area in Australia. At that time, the SS Yongala was on her 99th voyage from Brisbane with stops at Melbourne and Mackay and was headed to Townsville. The SS Yongala left Mackay at 1.40 pm and was sighted once more before the cyclone hit; she is believed to have sunk with all passengers and crew



YONGALA

- Mr. S. M. H. Emerson, Australian crew member aboard the ship "SS Yongala" when she went missing in a Cyclone on 23-24 March 1911 everyone was presumed dead

VIMY RIDGE

During World War I Vimy Ridge fell under German control in 1914 in the race to secure the sea. For the next few years the Franco-British and German forces attempted to outflank each other, with many casualties on both sides, by 1916 the British relieved the French Tenth Army, soon after they discovered the Germans tunnelling companies had tunnels and deep mines from which they would attack, the Royal Engineers tried to combat the German mining operations intensifying the battle. In 1916 Canadian Corps relieved troops along the western slopes of Vimy Ridge in October 1916.

For the first time all four divisions of the Canadian Expeditionary Force would fight together, combined with the British 5th Division this brought 170,000 men together, 97,184 were Canadian. The Canadian Corps were to capture the German-held high ground of Vimy Ridge, by February 1917 preparations began for an attack. British tunnelling companies created extensive underground networks and fortifications, including 13 secret mines under German positions. In February 637 Canadians were lost in trench raiding, raids between each side were being conducted nightly with an additional 1,400 casualties. At 5.30am on the 9th April 1917 the Canadian Corps began firing every artillery piece at their disposal at the Germans, with the aid of the British and French by the 12th April 1917 the Canadian Corps was in firm control of the ridge. 100 ha (250-acre) portion of the former battleground serves as a memorial park and site of the Canadian National Vimy Memorial.



RICHARD JACK-THE TAKING OF VIMY RIDGE (CWM 19710261-0160)

SURNAME VARIANTS OF EMERSON

- Thomas Amerson (d.1917) Canadian Private in the 102nd Battalion who died at Vimy Ridge April 1917



AMERICAN SETTLERS

- William Emerson, who arrived in Virginia in 1618 aboard the ship "Sampson" ^[8]
- Thomas Emerson, aged 11, who arrived in Virginia in 1623 aboard the ship "George" ^[8]
- Mrs. Ann Emerson, settled in Virginia in 1623 from Durham aboard the ship "George"
- Ellis Emerson, who arrived in Virginia in 1623 aboard the ship "George" ^[8]
- Jo Emerson, aged 20, British settler who arrived in New England in 1635 aboard the ship "Abigail" ^[8]
- Thomas Emerson, who arrived in Ipswich, Massachusetts in 1639 ^[8]
- Nicholas Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1642 ^[8]
- John Emerson, who landed in Ipswich, Massachusetts in 1648 ^[8]
- Ed Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1651 ^[8]
- Nicholas Emerson, who settled in Virginia in 1653
- Mich Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1653 ^[8]
- Michael Emerson, who arrived in Massachusetts in 1656 ^[8]
- Humphrey Emerson, who arrived in Maryland in 1663 ^[8]
- Paul Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1664 ^[8]
- Anthony Emerson, who arrived in Maryland in 1665 ^[8]
- Joseph Emerson, who arrived in Massachusetts in 1667 ^[8]
- Robert Emerson, who landed in New England in 1668 ^[8]
- Hannah Emerson, who arrived in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania in 1697-1700 ^[8]
- Henry Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1703 ^[8]
- Susanna Emerson, who arrived in Virginia in 1714 ^[8]
- Tho Emerson, who landed in Virginia in 1717 ^[8]
- Mrs. Emerson, who landed in New York, NY in 1811 ^[8]
- Jonas Emerson, who landed in Charleston, South Carolina in 1812 ^[8]
- J Emerson, who landed in San Francisco, California in 1850 ^[8]
- S A Emerson, who landed in San Francisco, California in 1850 ^[8]
- Mr. Emerson, who arrived in San Francisco, California in 1851 ^[8]

- S Emerson, who arrived in San Francisco, California in 1851 ^[8]
- P Emerson, who arrived in San Francisco, California in 1851 ^[8]
- G E Emerson, who arrived in San Francisco, California in 1851 ^[8]
- William Emerson, who landed in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1868 ^[8]
- James Emerson, who landed in San Francisco, California in 1872 ^[8]
- Thomas R Emerson, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1877 ^[8]
- Richard Emerson, who arrived in Allegany (Allegheny) County, Pennsylvania in 1878 ^[8]

CANADIAN SETTLERS

- George Emerson, who landed in Nova Scotia in 1750
- William Emerson, who landed in Nova Scotia in 1760
- Mr. John Emerson U.E. who settled in Eastern District [Cornwall], Ontario c. 1784 ^[23]
- Mr. Thomas Emerson U.E. who settled in St. Andrews, New Brunswick c. 1784 ^[23]
- Mr. Thomas Emerson U.E. who settled in New Brunswick c. 1784 he served in the 74th Regiment ^[23]

AUSTRALIAN SETTLERS

- George Emerson, aged 41, a labourer, who arrived in South Australia in 1852 aboard the ship "Standard" ^[24]
- Robert Emerson, aged 22, a labourer, who arrived in South Australia in 1855 aboard the ship "Lismoyne"

NEW ZEALAND SETTLERS

- Elizabeth Emerson, who arrived in Auckland, New Zealand aboard the ship "Nimroud" in 1863
- Elizabeth Emerson, aged 43, a dairy woman, who arrived in Lyttelton, New Zealand aboard the ship "Siberia" in 1870
- Fanny Emerson, aged 24, a dairymaid, who arrived in Lyttelton, New Zealand aboard the ship "Siberia" in 1870
- Eleanor Emerson, aged 22, a dairymaid, who arrived in Lyttelton, New Zealand aboard the ship "Siberia" in 1870
- Elizabeth Emerson, aged 20, a dairymaid, who arrived in Lyttelton, New Zealand aboard the ship "Siberia" in 1870





Here is a listing of some of the sources consulted when researching British surnames. The resources below directly or indirectly influenced the authors of our surname histories. We have most of these titles in our library, others we have borrowed or had access to. Source materials have been chosen for their reliability and authenticity. Our research into surnames is ongoing, and we are continually adding to our source library. For each surname history, we seek and refer to sources specific to the surname; these are generally not included in the list below.

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<http://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/>

The National Archives (USA): <http://www.archives.gov/>

College of Arms (England): <http://college-of-arms.gov.uk/>

MEDIEVAL ROLLS

Where available we consult Medieval rolls or use their information as reprinted in secondary sources.

Subsidy Rolls: taxation records from the 12th to the 17th centuries.

Assize Rolls: records from court sessions

Pipe Rolls: rolls of the Exchequer of accounts of the royal income, arranged by county, for each financial year. Many 12th and 13th century documents have been published with indexes by the Pipe Roll Society.

Calendarium Inquisitionum Post Mortem: Feudal inquiries, undertaken after the death of a feudal tenant in chief to establish what lands were held and who should succeed to them. Records exist from around 1240-1660.

Roll of Battle Abbey: a list of the principal Norman Knights said to have accompanied William across the English Channel. Original roll was lost.

Curia Regis Rolls (*Rotuli Curiae Regis*): Rolls and Records of the Court held before the king's Justices. Various translated and published, London 1835),

Feet of Fines: Legal agreements, usually about property ownership

Register of the Freemen of York: list of freemen from 13th-18th century, published by the Surtees Society, Francis Collins (editor) in 1897.

Charters: documents recording grants, usually of land recorded by the Chancery

Historia Regum Britanniae ("The History of the Kings of Britain"): a legendary account of British history, accredited to Geoffrey of Monmouth in around 1136.

Heralds' visitations: 16th-17th century, county by county visits to regulate the use of arms; many published by the Harleian Society.

Hundred Rolls (*Rotuli Hundredorum*): various royal inquests, documents were held in the tower of London. Much was published in 1818 Ragman Rolls: rolls of deeds on parchment in which the Scottish nobility and gentry subscribed allegiance to Edward I. of England, A. D. 1296.

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